

M.Cecilia Ramírez Michelena

✉ mcramirezmicelena@gmail.com ☎ +34-666-399-085 📍 Based in Barcelona, open to relocation

Professional Summary

Economist and Ph.D. candidate specializing in quantitative research and impact evaluation, with field experience across Latin America, the US, and Europe. Skilled in translating empirical findings into actionable policy insights. Research focuses on education, labor markets, gender, and social protection.

Professional Experience

Institut d'Economia de Barcelona (Universitat de Barcelona)

01/2023 – Present

Predoctoral Researcher

Barcelona, Spain

- Predoctoral instructor and researcher, conducting doctoral research in education and labor economics.
- Evaluate the educational impacts of on- and off-grid school electrification in developing settings, focusing on student outcomes and teacher quality.
- Quantify the evolution of the gender wage gap and child penalty in Spain using administrative social security data.
- Analyze how childhood and adolescent abilities shape career choices, with a focus on the underrepresentation of women in STEM. Lead the design and upcoming implementation of a randomized information intervention (RCT) for middle school Catalan students, funded by the *Women and Science Program* (Paris Dauphine–PSL University).

The Education Policy Analytics Lab (University of Washington)

09/2018 – 09/2019

Research Assistant

Seattle, US

- Partnered exclusively with Seattle Public Schools (SPS)—the largest K–12 provider in Washington State—in a joint research initiative to improve teacher effectiveness and reduce educational inequities.
- Conducted statistical analysis of administrative data to identify drivers of teacher absenteeism, recruitment gaps, and retention challenges, focusing on schools serving low-income students.
- Collaborated closely with SPS leadership, including district executives, analysts, teacher unions, and program managers, to co-design policy evaluation strategies.
- Presented analytical findings and policy recommendations to stakeholders to inform the implementation of targeted interventions.

Center for Research in Applied Economics (Universidad de Montevideo)

06/2015 – 07/2018

Research Assistant

Montevideo, Uruguay

- Designed and managed the operational implementation of two randomized controlled trials (RCTs) with vulnerable populations, developing field protocols and coordinating execution for interventions involving more than 300 informal street workers and over 120 institutionalized older adults.
- Contributed to survey design, data collection, and quantitative analysis.
- Led coordination with ministries, municipal departments, and frontline service providers to secure institutional access, operational support, and policy alignment.
- Co-authored academic and policy publications and supported dissemination to policy and research audiences.

Education

Universitat de Barcelona

Ph.D. in Economics

10/2021 – Expected 09/2026

Dissertation: *Essays on Education and Labor Economics*, supervised by Profs. Lúdia Farré and Andreu Arenas.

University of Washington

M.Ed. in Educational Foundations, Leadership, and Policy Studies

2021

Specialization in *Organizational and Policy Studies*.

M.A. in Economics

2021

Universidad de Montevideo

M.A. in Economics	2020
B.A. in Economics	2016
B.A. in Management and Business Administration	2016

Grants & Fellowships

Fellowships

Dr. Joan Guinovart Fellowship, Societat Econòmica Barcelonesa d'Amics del País (2025).

Doctoral Fellowship, Fundación Ramón Areces (2023 – 2026).

Doctoral Fellowship, Generalitat de Catalunya (2023).

Graduate Fellowship, University of Washington (2018 – 2020).

Fulbright Scholarship for Graduate Studies, The Fulbright Commission (2018 – 2020).

Research Scholarship, Universidad de Montevideo (2016 – 2018).

Research Grants

Women and Science Program, Paris Dauphine–PSL University – (EUR 10,000) (2024).

Teaching Experience & Student Supervision

Universitat de Barcelona – B.A. Thesis Advisor.

2026

Universitat de Barcelona – Instructor, Department of Economics.

Spring 2024, 2025

University of Washington – Instructor, Department of Spanish and Portuguese Studies.

Fall 2020 – Spring 2021

Universidad de Montevideo – Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics.

Fall 2014 – Spring 2015

Technical Skills & Languages

Statistical Tools: Stata, R, Python, Matlab. **Other:** LaTeX.

Languages: Spanish (native) - English (fluent) - Catalan (intermediate, B1 completed; B2 in progress).

Publications & Ongoing Research

- Arenas, A., Farré, L., Ramírez-Michelena, M. *Abilities and Career Choices: Addressing the Gender Gap in STEM Fields*. Working Paper.
- Blanco, M., D'Agosti, N., Ramírez-Michelena, M. *Educational gains from on- and off-grid school electrification in rural areas*. Working Paper.
- Arenas, A., Farré, L., Ramírez-Michelena, M. *The evolution of the child penalty and the gender wage gap in Spain*. Working Paper.
- Cid, A., Cabrera, J.M., Ramírez-Michelena, M., Blanco, M. *Strategies to increase the take-up of social benefits: Evidence from a field experiment*. Working Paper.
- Cid, A., Sotelo, R., Leguisamo, M., Ramírez-Michelena, M. *Tablets for deeply disadvantaged older adults: Challenges in long-term care facilities*. International Journal of Human-Computer Studies (2020).

References

- Lidia Farré**, Tenured Scientist, *Institut d'Anàlisi Econòmica* (IAE-CSIC); Affiliated Professor, *Barcelona School of Economics* (BSE) – lidia.farre@gmail.com
- Andreu Arenas**, Senior Quantitative Analyst, *Iválua*; Research Fellow, *Barcelona Institute of Economics* (IEB) - *Universitat de Barcelona* (UB) – andreu.arenas@ivalua.cat
- Juan Dubra**, Tenured Professor, *Universidad de Montevideo* (UM) – dubraj@um.edu.uy